



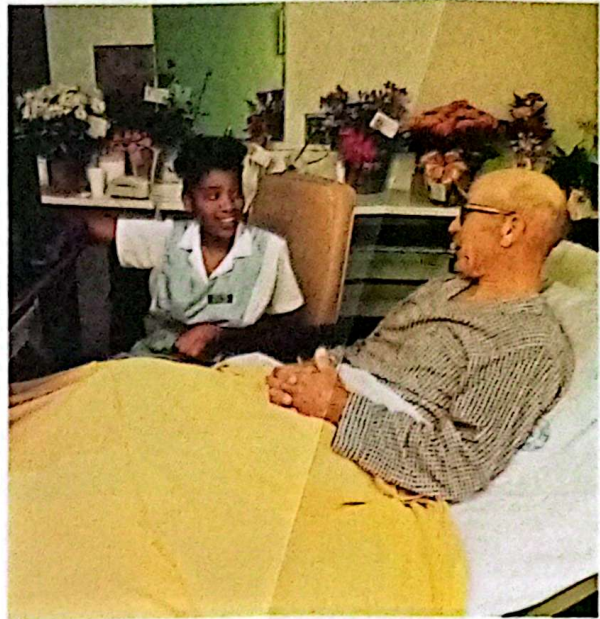
How to Volunteer for Community Service

A volunteer is someone who provides a service to the community without getting paid. Perhaps you have helped out with a school food drive or worked with students in the library. If so, you already have some volunteer experience.

Volunteer Opportunities

Opportunities to do volunteer work exist all around you.

- **Local hospitals.** In most hospitals, volunteers visit patients and perform services to make their stay more pleasant. Some hospitals have volunteer programs for teens. This enables students to become familiar with hospital work to see if they want to pursue a medical career.
- **Volunteer fire departments and rescue squads.** Volunteers usually start in their mid- or late teens to learn the skills they need to become firefighters. Being a volunteer firefighter is an important job you can do for your community.
- **Libraries.** Public libraries often use teenage volunteers to help shelve books, work with students, and help at the circulation desk.
- **Nursing homes and daycare centers.** Like hospitals, these are two very good places to learn care-giving skills you can use in careers such as medicine, nursing, and child care. Many elderly people in nursing homes have no family to visit them.



Student volunteer at nursing home

By volunteering you can help brighten their days.

- **Schools.** Many schools have programs in which older students tutor younger ones. If you are very good at one or two subjects, check with your school office to see if you can tutor someone else in those subjects.

To volunteer for any of these jobs, look up the organization in your telephone directory, and call. If one agency cannot use your help, try another. There is always a need for volunteers.

CITIZENSHIP IN ACTION

- 1 Why do you think volunteer work is an important way to practice good citizenship?
- 2 What kind of volunteer work would you like to do? Why?